



**NSW
National
Parks
and Wildlife
Service**

Royal National Park

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All the practical information you need to know about Royal National Park.

Getting there and parking

From Sydney:

- Royal National Park's main entry points are along the Princes Highway
- Turn off the highway at either Farnell Avenue, just south of Loftus, or at McKell Avenue at Waterfall.

From Wollongong:

- You can reach the park along the Princes Highway, or via Otford which is north of Stanwell Park.

Roads in the Royal National Park can be extremely busy and traffic delays should be expected on weekends and public holidays during summer. For up to date traffic information we recommend people check www.livetraffic.com

If you prefer to leave the car at home, many attractions in Royal National Park can be accessed via public transport.

P Parking [show more](#)

- Audley boatshed
- Audley Dance Hall Cafe
- Bonnie Vale picnic area
- Currawong Flat picnic area
- Governor Game lookout

Road quality

- Sealed roads

Vehicle access

- 2WD vehicles

Parking

Follow [@royalnpalerts](#) on Twitter for regular, real-time updates on the amount of parking available in the park, and information about any traffic control measures that have been applied.

By bike

Check out the [Bicycle information for NSW website](#) for more information.

By public transport

Train

Some attractions in Royal National Park can be accessed from train stations including Cronulla, Loftus, Heathcote, Waterfall, and Otford train station at the southern end of the national park. Visit the [Transport NSW website](#) for more information.

Ferry

From Cronulla, you can take the ferry to Bundeena.

Best times to visit

Royal National Park covers a wide range of landscapes, from open grassland to ocean-fronting clifftops. It's a good idea to pack clothing suitable for all weather conditions along with water, sunscreen and a map on your visit. Royal National Park shines in all seasons, though summer and winter each offer a few special attractions.

Spring

Plan a visit during spring to admire the stunning heathland wildflowers on display. Head along the Coast track or the Curra Moors Loop track or walk to Wisers track to see them in bloom.

Summer

Visit the majestic Garie Beach to surf or just relax. The panorama from Garie North Head is just amazing, so be sure to take your camera. The beach at Bundeena's Bonnie Vale is a great swimming spot, as are Jibbon Beach and Wattamolla lagoon. If a freshwater swim is more your thing, try Karloo Pool, Deer Pool or Curracurrang.

Winter

Winter is a great time to tackle the popular Coast track from Bundeena to Otford. Not only will you be greeted by spectacular coastal scenery, you can also see whales from the cliffs between June and August. Complete the walk in small sections or undertake the entire 26km over two days.

Weather, temperature and rainfall



Summer temperature

Average

16°C and 27°C

Highest recorded

42°C (1977)



Winter temperature

Average

6°C and 17°C

Lowest recorded

-0.6°C (1968)



Rainfall

Wettest month

March

The area's highest recorded rainfall in one day

254.5mm

Facilities



Toilets [show more](#)

- [Audley boatshed](#)
- [Audley Dance Hall Cafe](#)
- [Bonnie Vale campground](#)
- [Bonnie Vale picnic area](#)
- [Bungoona lookout and path](#)



Showers

- [Bonnie Vale campground](#)
- [Hilltop Cottage](#)
- [Reids Flat Cottage](#)
- [Weemalah Cottage](#)



Picnic tables [show more](#)

- [Audley boatshed](#)
- [Audley Dance Hall Cafe](#)
- [Bonnie Vale campground](#)
- [Bonnie Vale picnic area](#)
- [Bungoona lookout and path](#)



Barbecue facilities [show more](#)

- [Audley boatshed](#)
- [Bonnie Vale campground](#)
- [Bonnie Vale picnic area](#)
- [Currawong Flat picnic area](#)
- [Hilltop Cottage](#)



Cafe/kiosk [show more](#)

- [Audley boatshed](#)

- [Audley Dance Hall Cafe](#)
- [Hilltop Cottage](#)
- [Ironbark Flat picnic area](#)
- [Reids Flat Cottage](#)



Drinking water [show more](#)

- [Audley boatshed](#)
- [Audley Dance Hall Cafe](#)
- [Bonnie Vale campground](#)
- [Bonnie Vale picnic area](#)
- [Currawong Flat picnic area](#)



Public phone

Large areas of this park have no mobile reception.

- [Audley Dance Hall Cafe](#)



Electric power

- [Hilltop Cottage](#)
- [Reids Flat Cottage](#)
- [Weemalah Cottage](#)

Maps and downloads



Royal National Park factsheet



Royal National Park map (9.8MB pdf)



Audley visitor area map (627.1KB pdf)



Bonnie Vale visitor area map (620.1KB pdf)

Fees and passes

Park entry fees:

\$12 per vehicle per day. Payment options include Royal National Park Visitor Centre, vehicle entry stations, pay machines and the [Park'nPay app](#).

Vehicles over 8 seats: \$4.40 per adult, \$2.20 per child (per day). Teachers/educational supervisors: free (1 adult per 10 students).

- All Parks Pass - For all parks in NSW (including Kosciuszko NP) \$190 (1 year) / \$335 (2 years)
- Multi Parks Pass - For all parks in NSW (except Kosciuszko) \$65 (1 year) / \$115 (2 years)

Annual passes and entry fees (<https://www.nationalparks.nsw.gov.au/passes-and-fees>).

Safety messages

However you discover NSW national parks and reserves, we want you to have a safe and enjoyable experience. Our park and reserve systems contrast greatly so you need to be aware of the risks and take responsibility for your own safety and the safety of those in your care.

Remember that parks are natural environments and can be unpredictable. See our general tips on staying safe in parks.



Beach safety

Beaches in this park are not patrolled by lifeguards and can have strong rip currents. The safest place to swim is at a patrolled beach, between the red and yellow flags. Check the Beachsafe website [↗](#) to find the nearest patrolled beach. These beach safety tips will help you and your family stay safe in the water.



Bushwalking safety

If you're keen to head out on a longer walk or a backpack camp, always be prepared. Read these bushwalking safety tips before you set off on a walking adventure in national parks.



Camping safety

Whether you're pitching your tent on the coast or up on the mountains, there are many things to consider when camping in NSW national parks. Find out how to stay safe when camping.



Cycling safety

Hundreds of cyclists head to our national parks for fun and adventure. If you're riding your bike through a national park, read these mountain biking and cycling safety tips.



Fishing safety

Fishing from a boat, the beach, the rocks or by the river is a popular activity for many national park visitors. If you're planning a day out fishing, check out these fishing and rock fishing safety tips.



Mobile safety

Dial Triple Zero (000) in an emergency. Download the Emergency Plus app [↗](#) before you visit, it helps emergency services locate you using your smartphone's GPS. Please note there is limited mobile phone reception in this park and you'll need mobile reception to call Triple Zero (000).



Water activities

Beaches, rivers and lakes in NSW national parks offer lots of opportunities for water activities. Please take care in the water and find out how to help your family and friends stay safe around water.

Prohibited



Camp fires and solid fuel burners

Wood fires and camp fires are prohibited in Royal National Park. Gas or heat bead cookers are permitted if they are elevated off the ground and if residues are cooled and placed in a bin. However gas and heat bead cookers are also prohibited if a total fire ban is declared.



Drones

Flying a drone for recreational purposes is prohibited in this area. Drones may affect public enjoyment, safety and privacy, interfere with park operations, or pose a threat to wildlife. See the [Drones in Parks policy](#) [↗](#).

This area may be a declared Drone Exclusion Zone, or may be subject to Civil Aviation Safety Authority (CASA) rules for flying near airports, aerodromes and helicopter landing sites. See [CASA's Drone Flyer Rules](#) [↗](#).

Commercial filming and photography

Commercial filming or photography is prohibited without prior consent. You must [apply for permission](#) [↗](#) and [contact the local office](#) [↗](#).



Pets

Pets and domestic animals (other than certified assistance animals) are not permitted. Find out which [regional parks allow dog walking](#) and see the [pets in parks policy](#) [↗](#) for more information.

Pets are not permitted in NSW national parks and reserves, however you can enjoy dog walking in [these regional parks](#). Assistance animals can be accompanied in national park areas open to the public.



Smoking

NSW national parks are [no smoking areas](#).

Contact

in the [Sydney and surrounds](#) and [South Coast](#) regions

Royal National Park is open 7am to 8.30pm but may have to close at times due to poor weather or fire danger.

Park entry fees:

\$12 per vehicle per day. Payment options include Royal National Park Visitor Centre, vehicle entry stations, pay machines and the [Park'nPay app](#) [↗](#).

Vehicles over 8 seats: \$4.40 per adult, \$2.20 per child (per day). Teachers/educational supervisors: free (1 adult per 10 students).

[Buy annual pass](#)

 Royal National Park Visitor Centre
02 9542 0648
1300 072 757 for campground and cottage bookings
Contact hours: 8.30am to 4.30pm daily. Closed Christmas Day.

2 Lady Carrington Drive, Audley, NSW 2232

Email: npws.royal@environment.nsw.gov.au

Visitor centre

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Nearby towns

Heathcote (7 km)

Just 36km south of Sydney, Heathcote offers easy access to Heathcote National Park and Royal National Park – the world's second-oldest national park. The heritage-listed Royal National Park offers a range of recreational activities – including bushwalking, cycling and surfing – and places to relax and enjoy a meal in natural surroundings.

www.sutherlandshire.nsw.gov.au 

Sydney City Centre (33 km)

No trip to Sydney is complete without spending some time in the city's beautiful parks. Whether it's in central areas like [Hyde Park](#)  or the [Royal Botanic Gardens](#)  or further out in [Centennial Parklands](#) , there's plenty of green space to go out and enjoy.

www.sydney.com 

Wollongong (38 km)

There are plenty of opportunities for adventure activities in and around Wollongong ranging from [surfing](#)  and swimming to sailing, hang gliding, paragliding, cycling and abseiling. Wollongong is the only place in NSW where you can [skydive](#)  onto the beach.

www.visitnsw.com 